

Group Benefits Administration

Standard Operating Procedure

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Owner	Group Business — Policy Operations
Approved By	Head of Group Insurance
Classification	Internal Use Only
Applicable To	All group insurance programmes administered by Meridian Insurance Group for employers and affinity groups

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the process for developing, onboarding, administering, and renewing group insurance programmes for employer and affinity group clients. It establishes clear responsibilities across Meridian and the group administrator to ensure accurate member enrolment, billing reconciliation, claims eligibility, and programme governance.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- New group programme setup for employers, associations, and affinity groups
- Member enrolment additions, deletions, and amendments throughout the policy year
- Annual group programme renewal and premium renegotiation
- Group billing reconciliation and premium collection from the master policyholder

This procedure does NOT cover: individual policies issued under a group master arrangement on a voluntary basis (refer SOP-INS-004), or reinsurance treaty administration.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Insurance Representative (Group Account Manager)	Primary relationship owner for the group client; leads programme design and renewal negotiations; coordinates with internal teams throughout the policy year.
Application Processor	Receives and validates member enrolment data; processes additions and deletions in the group billing system; resolves data discrepancies with the group administrator.
New Business Specialist	Coordinates new group programme setup in PAS; ensures master policy is issued within SLA; prepares group certificates of insurance; configures billing arrangement with Finance.
Compliance Officer	Ensures group programme terms comply with applicable regulations; reviews master policy wording; advises on regulatory requirements for specific industries or group sizes.

4. Pre-requisites and Triggers

New programme: triggered by a signed group proposal or heads of terms. Enrolment changes: triggered by monthly data file received from the group administrator. Renewal: triggered by PAS 90 days before master policy anniversary.

5. Process Steps

5.1 New Group Programme Setup

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
1	Signed proposal received from group client	Group Account Manager	Proposal filed; implementation timeline agreed; kickoff meeting scheduled

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
2	Group programme structured and underwritten	New Business Specialist / Underwriting	Benefits schedule, eligibility rules, and pricing confirmed; subgroup structure defined if applicable
3	Master policy drafted and reviewed by Compliance	New Business Specialist / Compliance	Policy wording approved; schedule of benefits attached; executed by both parties via DocuSign
4	Group configured in PAS and billing system	New Business Specialist	Master policy number assigned; benefit codes, eligibility rules, and billing cycle loaded
5	Group administrator onboarding	Group Account Manager	Training provided on member data submission format and portal access; group admin guide distributed
6	Initial member data file received and processed	Application Processor	Member records loaded into PAS; individual certificates of insurance generated and dispatched to group admin for distribution

5.2 Ongoing Member Administration

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
7	Monthly member data file received from group admin	Application Processor	File received by 5th of each month; format validated against agreed template
8	Data file processed: additions, deletions, amendments	Application Processor	Changes effective from the date confirmed in the file; PAS updated; billing adjusted accordingly
9	Discrepancy resolution	Application Processor	Errors returned to group admin within 2 business days; corrected file required within 5 business days
10	Monthly group invoice generated and dispatched	New Business Specialist / Finance	Invoice reflects current member count and benefit level; sent to group admin by 10th of each month
11	Premium payment received and reconciled	Finance / Application Processor	Payment matched to invoice; exceptions resolved; GL posted in SAP

5.3 Annual Programme Renewal

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
12	Renewal analysis prepared by Group Account Manager	Group Account Manager / Actuarial	Loss ratio, claims experience, and membership trend analysis; renewal pricing recommendation prepared

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
13	Renewal terms presented to group client	Group Account Manager	Renewal meeting held; revised benefits schedule and premium presented
14	Renewal accepted and documented	Group Account Manager / Compliance	Revised master policy endorsed or reissued; new anniversary date confirmed in PAS

6. Decision Points and Exception Handling

6.1 Member Data File Not Received

- Application Processor follows up with group administrator on the 6th of the month
- If not received by the 10th: Group Account Manager escalates to group client's HR contact
- Billing is held and the prior month's membership is used as a provisional basis, subject to retroactive adjustment

6.2 Group Premium Arrears

- 30-day arrears: formal written notice to group administrator
- 60-day arrears: Group Account Manager engages client; payment plan may be arranged with Finance Director approval
- 90-day arrears: programme suspended; members notified that coverage is under review

6.3 Renewal Declined by Client

- Master policy run-off provisions apply; all claims incurred before expiry are honoured up to the run-off period
- Member data securely archived per data retention policy; access rights revoked for group admin portal

7. Systems and Tools

System / Tool	Purpose	Access
Policy Administration System (PAS)	Master policy, member records, certificate generation	All roles
Group Billing System (Sapiens)	Monthly invoicing, member-level billing, reconciliation	Application Processor, Finance
Group Admin Portal	Member data file submission, invoice download, certificate access	Group Administrator
SAP S/4HANA	Premium GL posting, accounts receivable	Finance
DocuSign	Master policy execution	New Business Specialist, Group Client
CRM (Salesforce)	Group account management, renewal tracking, relationship history	Group Account Manager

8. Key Performance Indicators

- New group setup cycle time: Master policy issued within 15 business days of signed proposal
- Enrolment processing timeliness: 100% of monthly data files processed by the 15th of each month
- Billing accuracy rate: Minimum 97% of group invoices issued without amendment
- Premium collection rate: Minimum 95% of group premiums collected within agreed terms
- Annual renewal retention: Minimum 88% of group clients renewed at anniversary

9. Related Documents

- SOP-INS-004: Prospect-to-Issue
- SOP-INS-007: Medical Claims Processing
- POL-UW-003: Group Underwriting Policy
- POL-FIN-002: Premium Collection and Billing Policy

10. Document Control and Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	01 Jul 2022	N. Tan, Group Business	Initial release
1.1	15 Apr 2024	N. Tan, Group Business	Added group admin portal steps; revised invoicing SLAs
1.2	01 Apr 2025	S. Mehta, Operations	Added arrears escalation protocol; updated renewal steps with actuarial sign-off